

oblong to ovate, glossy, bright green leaves. Rounded heads of tubular, creamy-white flowers are borne in late spring, followed by egg-shaped, red-stalked, red fruits that ripen to black. Z5–9

V. tinus (Laurustinus). Evergreen, bushy, compact shrub. H and S 10ft (3m). Has ovate, dark green leaves. Freely borne flat heads of small, white blooms open from pink buds during late winter and spring, followed by ovoid dark blue-black fruit. Z7–9. ‘**Eve Price**’ illus. p.143. ‘**French White**’ is vigorous, with flattened heads of tiny white flowers opening from deep pink buds. ‘**Gvenillian**’ freely bears flattened heads of star-shaped, pale pink flowers from deep pink buds, followed by abundant fruits.

VIGNA

PAPILIONACEAE/LEGUMINOSAE

Genus of erect and climbing or trailing annuals and evergreen perennials, grown mainly as crop plants for their leaves, pods and seeds. Frost tender. Provide full light and humus-rich, well-drained soil. Water freely when in full growth, sparingly at other times. Stems require support. Thin crowded stems or cut back hard in spring. Propagate by seed in fall or spring.

V. caracalla, syn. *Phaseolus caracalla* (Snail flower). Evergreen, perennial, fast-growing, twining climber. H 10–15ft (3–5m). Leaves comprise 3 ovate leaflets. From summer to early fall, produces pealike, purple-marked, cream flowers that turn orange-yellow. Z11–12 (min. 50–59°F/10–15°C)

Villarsia nymphoides. See *Nymphoides peltata*.

VINCA

Periwinkle

APOCYNACEAE

Genus of evergreen, trailing subshrubs and herbaceous perennials, grown for their foliage and flowers. Flowers are tubular with 5 spreading lobes. Fully to frost hardy. Useful for groundcover in shade, but flowers more freely in some sun. Grows in any soil that is not too dry. Propagate by semiripe cuttings in summer or by division from fall to spring. ☉ All parts may cause mild stomach upset if ingested.

V. difformis. Evergreen, prostrate subshrub. H 1ft (30cm), S indefinite. Slender, trailing stems bear ovate, glossy, dark green leaves. Erect flower stems produce pale blue flowers in late fall and early winter. Z8–10

V. herbacea ‘Hidcote Purple’. See *V. major* var. *oxyloba*.

V. hirsuta of gardens. See *V. major* var. *oxyloba*.

V. major (Greater periwinkle, Quater). Evergreen, prostrate, arching subshrub. H 1½ft (45cm), S indefinite. Has broadly ovate, glossy, dark green leaves. Large, bright blue flowers are borne from late spring to early fall. Z7–9. ‘**Dartington Star**’ see *V.m.* var. *oxyloba*. **var. oxyloba** (syn. *V.m.* ‘Dartington Star’, *V. herbacea* ‘Hidcote Purple’, *V. hirsuta* of gardens) has leaves, leaf stalks, and calyces edged with long hairs. ‘**Variegata**’ illus. p.164.

V. minor (Lesser periwinkle) illus. p.165.

‘Alba Aureovariegata’ see *V.m.* f. *alba* ‘Alba Variegata’. **f. alba ‘Alba Variegata’** (syn. *V.m.* ‘Alba Aureovariegata’) is an evergreen, prostrate subshrub. H 6in (15cm), S indefinite. Forms extensive mats of small, ovate, glossy, dark green leaves, edged with pale yellow, above which white flowers are borne from mid-spring to early summer, then intermittently into fall.

‘Argenteovariegata’ (syn. *V.m.* ‘Variegata’) has leaves with creamy white margins and produces light violet-blue flowers. **‘Atropurpurea’** (syn. *V.m.* ‘Purpurea’, *V.m.* ‘Rubra’) bears dark plum-purple flowers. **‘Azurea Flore Pleno’** (syn. *V.m.* ‘Caerulea Plena’) has double, sky-blue flowers. **‘Bowles’ Blue’** see *V.m.* ‘La Grave’. **‘Caerulea Plena’** see *V.m.* ‘Azurea Flore Pleno’. **‘Gertrude Jekyll’** is of dense growth and bears a profusion of small, white flowers. Flowers of **‘La Grave’** (syn. *V.m.* ‘Bowles’ Blue’) are large and lavender-blue. **‘Purpurea’** see *V.m.* ‘Atropurpurea’. **‘Ralph Shugert’** has gray-green leaves with irregular, white margins and abundant, large, mid-blue flowers. **‘Rubra’** see *V.m.* ‘Atropurpurea’. **‘Variegata’** see *V.m.* ‘Argenteovariegata’. Z3–9.

V. rosea. See *Catharanthus roseus*.

VIOLA

Violet

VIOLACEAE

Genus of annuals, biennials, evergreen, semievergreen, and deciduous perennials, and a few deciduous subshrubs, grown for their distinctive flowers. Annuals are suitable as summer bedding, perennials and subshrubs suit rock gardens, screes, and alpine houses. Fully to half hardy. Grow in sun or shade and well-drained, moisture-retentive soil, unless otherwise stated; a few species prefer acidic soil. Propagate annuals by seed sown according to flowering season, perennials and subshrubs by softwood cuttings in spring unless otherwise stated. Sow seed of species in spring or fall.

V. biflora (Twin-flowered violet). Creeping, rhizomatous perennial. H 2–6in (5–15cm), S 6in (15cm). Flat-faced, deep lemon-yellow flowers, veined dark brown, are borne singly or in pairs on upright stems in summer. Leaves are kidney-shaped and mid-green. Needs shade. May be propagated by division. Z3–8

V. ‘Bowles’ Black’ illus. p.355.

V. cornuta (Horned violet). Rhizomatous perennial. H 12–20cm (5–8in), S to 8in (20cm) or more. Has ovate, toothed leaves and flat-faced, angular, spurred, pale to deep purplish-blue, occasionally white flowers in spring and much of summer. Z6–11. **‘Minor’** illus. p.356.

V. cucullata, syn. *V. obliqua*. Variable, spreading perennial with fleshy rhizomes. H 2in (5cm), S 4–6in (10–15cm). Has kidney-shaped, toothed, mid-green leaves. In late spring, produces flat-faced, blue-violet, sometimes white or pale blue flowers. Propagate in spring. Z3–8

V. elatior, syn. *V. erecta*. Upright, little-branched perennial. H 8–12in (20–30cm), S 6in (15cm). Leaves are broadly lance-

shaped and toothed. Bears flat-faced, pale blue flowers, with white centers, in early summer. Prefers partial shade and moist soil. Propagate in spring by division. Z4–8

V. erecta. See *V. elatior*.

V. glabella. Clump-forming perennial with a scaly, horizontal rootstock. H 4in (10cm), S 8in (20cm). Produces flat-faced, bright yellow flowers, with purplish-veined lower petals, in late spring, above toothed, heart-shaped, bright green leaves. Needs shade. Propagate by division in spring. Z4–8

V. ‘Haslemere’. See *V. ‘Nellie Britton’*.

V. hederacea, syn. *Erpetion reniforme*, *V. reniforme* (Australian violet, Ivy-leaved violet). Evergreen, creeping, mat-forming perennial. H 1–2in (2.5–5cm), S indefinite. Has tiny, rounded leaves and, in summer, bears purple or white flowers, with a squashed appearance, on short stems. Suitable for growing in an alpine house. Prefers partial shade. Propagate by division in spring. Z8–10

V. ‘Huntercombe Purple’ illus. p.368.

V. ‘Irish Molly’. Evergreen, clump-forming, short-lived perennial. H 4in (10cm), S 6–8in (15–20cm). Has broadly ovate, dissected leaves and, in summer, produces a long succession of flat-faced, old-gold flowers with brown centers. Needs a position in sun. Z8–10

V. ‘Jackanapes’ illus. p.359.

V. lutea (Mountain pansy). Mat-forming, rhizomatous perennial. H 4in (10cm), S 6in (15cm). Has small, ovate to lance-shaped leaves. Flat-faced, yellow, violet, or bicolored flowers are borne in spring and summer. Z4–8

V. ‘Nellie Britton’, syn. *V. ‘Haslemere’*, illus. p.367.

V. obliqua. See *V. cucullata*.

V. odorata (Sweet violet). Semievergreen, spreading, rhizomatous perennial. H 3in (7cm), S 6in (15cm) or more. Leaves are heart-shaped and toothed. Long stems each bear a fragrant, flat-faced, violet or white flower from late winter to early spring. Useful in a wild garden. Self seeds prolifically. May also be propagated by division. Z3–8

V. pedata (Bird’s-foot violet) illus. p.355.

var. bicolor is a clump-forming perennial with a thick rootstock. H 2in (5cm), S 3in (8cm). Flat-faced, velvety-purple or white flowers are borne singly on slender stems in late spring and early summer. Leaves are finely divided into 5–7 or more, narrow, toothed segments. Suits an alpine house. May be difficult to grow; needs peaty, sandy soil. Z4–8

V. reniforme. See *V. hederacea*.

V. riviniana Purpurea Group illus. p.355.

V. tricolor (Heartsease, Wild pansy) illus. p.355.

V. x wittrockiana (Pansy). Group of slow- to moderately fast-growing, mainly bushy perennials, usually grown as annuals or biennials. H 6–8in (15–20cm), S 8in (20cm). Has ovate, often serrated, mid-green leaves. Flattish, 5-petaled flowers, 1–4in (2.5–10cm) across, in a very wide color range, are produced throughout summer or in winter–spring. H6. The following are among those available: **Clear Crystals Series** (summer-flowering) comes in a wide

range of clear colors. **Joker Series** (summer-flowering) illus. p.312. **‘Joker Light Blue’** (Joker Series) has pale blue flowers with deeper blue-and-white faces. **‘Majestic Giants’** (summer-flowering) has large flowers in a wide color range.

Mystical Series (winter- to spring-flowering) includes **‘Banana Cream’** (Mystical Series), with yellow and creamy white flowers, **‘Pineapple Crush’** (Mystical Series), with pink and yellow flowers with dark central blotches, and **‘Red Wing’** (Mystical Series), with yellow and maroon-red flowers. **Sorbet Series** (winter- to spring-flowering) has small flowers, with or without whiskers, in more than 20 color combinations. **‘Antique Shades’** (Sorbet Series) is compact, bearing copper-brown and purple flowers variously marked with golden yellow, orange and red. **‘Fire’** (Sorbet Series) produces rich yellow and red flowers with dark central blotches. **Halloween Mixed** (Sorbet Series) produces orange or deep blackish maroon flowers. **‘Sorbet Black Delight’** (Sorbet Series) illus. p.312. **Sorbet XP Series** (winter- to spring-flowering) has flowers in a wide color range, including self-colored and pansy-type, some with whiskering. **Teardrops Series** (winter- to spring-flowering) produces fragrant flowers in at least 8 colors; some are whiskered or have bold, darker central blotches.

Viscaria alpina. See *Lychnis alpina*.

Viscaria elegans. See *Silene coeli-rosa*.

VITALIANA

PRIMULACEAE

Genus of one species of evergreen, spring-flowering perennial, grown for its flowers. Often included in *Douglasia* and is useful for rock gardens, screes and alpine houses. Fully hardy. Needs sun and moist, well-drained soil. Propagate by softwood cuttings in summer or by seed in fall.

V. primuliflora, syn. *Douglasia vitaliana*, illus. p.358.

VITEX

LAMIACEAE/VERBENACEAE

Genus of evergreen or deciduous trees and shrubs, grown for their flowers. Fully to frost hardy. Cultivated species are frost hardy, but in cold areas grow against a south- or west-facing wall. Needs full sun and well-drained soil. Propagate by semiripe cuttings in summer or by seed in fall or spring.

V. agnus-castus (Chaste tree). Deciduous, spreading, aromatic shrub. H and S 8ft (2.5m). Bears upright panicles of fragrant, tubular, violet-blue flowers in early and mid-fall. Dark green leaves are divided into 5 or 7 long, narrowly lance-shaped leaflets. Z6–9. **f. latifolia** is more vigorous, with broader leaflets.

V. negundo. Deciduous, bushy shrub. H and S 10ft (3m). Mid-green leaves are each composed of 3–7 narrowly ovate, sharply toothed leaflets. Has loose panicles of small, tubular, violet-blue flowers from late summer through to early fall. Z6–9